Ch. 11 Non-Textbook Questions

Principles of Microeconomics

July 23, 2026

1. For centuries, salmon has been a staple food of Alaskans. When jetliners began flying tourists who love fishing to Anchorage in the 1950s, the stock of Alaskan salmon began falling.

   (a) Are Alaskan salmon a private good, a public good, or a common resource?

   (b) How does the market quantity compare to the socially optimal quantity of fish caught? Draw a graph.

   (c) What are two government policy interventions that could deal with this market failure?

2. Four roommates are thinking about hiring someone to clean their apartment. The cost of cleaning the apartment is \$20. One roommate's demand for cleanings is given by $Q_D = 5 - \frac{1}{2}P$. The other three roommates each have the same individual demand equation for cleanings, $Q_D = 3 - \frac{1}{2}P$.

   (a) What is the market demand for cleanings amongst the four roommates?

   (b) What is the optimal number of cleanings they should buy?

   (c) If the roommates didn't get along and couldn't work together long enough to hire a cleaner, would any of them individually pay for cleanings?